Kristi Esta

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https://kke005012.github.io/

SUMMARY

Data Engineer with over 20 years of experience building scalable data solutions and guiding cross-functional teams. Proficient in Python, SQL, and machine learning frameworks, with a strong focus on transforming complex challenges into data-driven insights. Demonstrated ability to collaborate with stakeholders to drive strategic decisions and optimize operational efficiencies. Completed 7-month AI/ML Post-Graduate Certificate for Business Applications in 2025.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming & Tools:** Python, SQL, Java, SQL/NoSQL, JSON, XML, HTML/CSS
- **Machine Learning & Analysis:** Python, Pandas, Seaborn, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Keras, Classification, Regression, Ensemble Methods, Neural Networks, Model Tuning, Statistical Principles, Computer Vision, Matplotlib, PyTorch, RAG, Gen AI, Vector DB
- **Data Engineering & Professional Attributes:** Technical Leadership (5 years), Python, Data pipelines, ETL, BMC, DataStage, Docker, Kubernetes, Cloud data platforms (AWS S3, Snowflake), SQL/NoSQL Relational and Columnar Database Platforms, Helm, Salesforce, Agile Methodologies and SAFe

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

USAA | *Senior Data Engineer* **May 2014 - Feb 2024**

- Maintained and enhanced large-scale data pipelines supporting real-time and batch ingestion of 2–5+ TB/day, enabling near-real-time operational analytics for banking business units.
- Served as Program Technical Lead for 3 engineering teams (25+ engineers), leading the migration of on-prem banking data platforms to AWS/Snowflake, resulting in improved scalability, reduced infrastructure overhead, and standardized containerized deployments using Kubernetes, Docker, Python, and Helm resulting in 30-40% reduction in data processing time and improved deployment reliability.
- Led delivery of multiple mortgage-focused software initiatives (2 years)**,** consistently delivering 100% on time and within budget while coordinating cross-functional engineering and business stakeholders.
- Coordinated and led a 13-engineer team extending DB2 and Hadoop platforms for the Bank Data Distribution Hub, supporting enterprise-wide data sharing across dozens of downstream consumers.
- Worked extensively with on-prem data (Hadoop, DB2, Netezza Platforms) utilizing query optimization, API creation (URL+endpoints), data lineage, security/compliance.
- Planned iterative development resources/tasks utilizing Agile/SaFE Methodology in Asana, Jira, RTC (Rational Team Concert) with Data Governance, Project Manager, Scrum Master, Stakeholder and Product Owner collaboration.
- Extended DB2 database and Hadoop platform for Bank data distribution hub (BODDH) as Tech Lead for a team of 13 engineers.
- Optimized complex queries and APIs across Hadoop, DB2, and Netezza platforms**,** improving query performance by 20–40% while supporting secure data access, lineage, and regulatory compliance.
- Cleansing of product data to improve data mining and analysis on banking trends for Data Scientists and Analysts.
- Developed first departmental Salesforce application, enhancing employee worklist flow codes for business users while allowing interactivity with users and data.
- Mentored junior and senior engineers.

USAA | Software Engineer **May 2006 - Dec 2014**

- Developed back-end services for USAA's first tablet e-sign application, streamlining document signing for Financial Brokers.
- Created back-end storage and data transformation solutions for usaa.com budgeting tools.
- Collaborated with the Tech Lead to design and implement a comprehensive budgeting database.
- Developed services to effectively transport, transform, and store budgeting data for USAA members.
- Engineered back-end services for the initial deployment of USAA’s employee tablet applications.Supported and maintained various Mortgage applications/Vendors for Bank applications.
- Coordinated disaster recovery efforts for Bank applications and managed batch processes for Bank.
- Contributed to expanding the documentation storage system for the first online lending application on usaa.com, which enabled members to enter, submit, and receive approvals.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

University of Texas – Austin **Feb 2025 – Oct 2025**

Post Graduate Program, Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning

- **Topics**: Supervised & unsupervised learning, data science, deep learning, model tuning, ensemble methods, Gen AI, RAG, Prompt Engineering, Computer Vision, fairness & explainability.
- AI/ML Projects (including Capstone project) - https://kke005012.github.io/

University of Louisiana at Monroe **Aug 2000 - Dec 2005**

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

2025 PROJECTS

DataCleanPro

- Cloud-based CSV cleaner: missing-value handling, currency/date normalization, dedupe, Stripe payments, and Gmail receipts.
- **Live App**
- Github Repository – currently set to Private; will temporarily set to Public if asked.

AI/ML Certification Projects

- HelmNet Computer Vision
  - Reading images to determine if workers are wearing hard hats or not to ensure workplace safety.
- SuperKart Sales Forecasting
  - Predictive Analytics and Deployment - Built and deployed a machine learning–based sales forecasting system to predict quarterly revenue across retail stores.
- Merck Manual RAG QA
  - Clinical question answering using RAG with careful chunking, retriever tuning, and groundedness/relevance evaluation.
- ReneWind
  - Neural-network modeling and preprocessing on energy data for forecasting and patterns using sensor output.

- Github Repository – set to Public